

TidyTuesday Week 38

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Saturday 19th September, 2026

Contents

1	Weekly Summary	2
2	Date: 2026-09-14	4
2.1	Raw Regression	4
2.2	Detrended Regression	6
3	Date: 2026-09-15	8
3.1	Raw Regression	8
3.2	Detrended Regression	10
4	Date: 2026-09-16	12
4.1	Raw Regression	12
4.2	Detrended Regression	14
5	Date: 2026-09-17	16
5.1	Raw Regression	16
5.2	Detrended Regression	18
6	Date: 2026-09-18	20
6.1	Raw Regression	20
6.2	Detrended Regression	22
7	Date: 2026-09-19	24
7.1	Raw Regression	24
7.2	Detrended Regression	26

1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to another week of shoving randomly selected economic time series into a blender and pretending the smoothie means something. As always, the machine dutifully paired up things that have no business being in the same sentence, ran the numbers twice, and left me to narrate the wreckage. Buckle up.

Monday kicked things off with a real crowd-pleaser: Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura house prices versus the gross fixed investment of financial businesses (a series so retired it's been discontinued since 2017). The raw regression came back with an R-squared of 0.87 and a p-value with more zeros than my bank account, which for one glorious moment made it look like California real estate and corporate equipment spending were soulmates. Then we detrended it, the R-squared face-planted to 0.23, and the "relationship" turned out to be two lines that both went up over several decades, like everything else in the economy. Classic trend mirage. Beautiful. Chef's kiss. This is the exact kind of result this project exists to point at and laugh.

Tuesday's San Luis Obispo house prices versus a discontinued loan-pricing series couldn't even manage a mirage — nothing significant raw, nothing significant detrended, just a shrug in numerical form. Wednesday, however, got weirdly interesting: distillate fuel commercial carbon emissions versus Japanese retail-trade stock surveys. The raw fit was a solid 0.48, and — plot twist — the detrended version actually stayed significant (p around 0.017), flipping to a negative relationship. So somewhere in the residuals, U.S. commercial heating-oil emissions and Japanese shopkeepers' feelings about their inventory are apparently doing a little dance together. I have absolutely no theory for this beyond "the universe is mocking me," but it earns the rare "huh, that held up" badge. Thursday delivered another survivor: U.S. Assets versus Asian business confidence held together in both the raw (barely, 0.08) and detrended (0.18, p around 0.0002) versions, which is genuinely more than most pairings manage — though the software did wave a giant "your numbers are enormous and possibly cursed" multicollinearity flag, so temper your excitement.

Friday gave us the week's tidiest cautionary tale: an emerging-markets corporate bond index versus the price of piped gas service. Raw R-squared of 0.73 with a triumphant near-zero p-value, then poof — detrended it collapsed to 0.06 and total insignificance. Two things drifting upward, holding hands, meaning nothing. To close us out, health-care "other separations" versus retail-trade hires was insignificant raw but crept into significance once detrended (p around 0.007), so file it under "mildly intriguing but probably still noise wearing a trench coat." The usual reminder, screamed from the rooftops: these are randomly paired series, there is no causal story here, and

spurious correlation is not the bug — it is the entire point of the exhibit. See you next week for more statistically significant nonsense.

2 Date: 2026-09-14

Series ID: ATNHPIUS37100Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Oxnard-Thousand Oaks-Ventura, CA (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1976-04-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 6.

Series ID: FBGFIEQ027S

This series is titled Financial business; gross fixed investment, nonresidential equipment, software, and structures, Flow (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate. The observation start date is 1946-10-01 and the observation end date is 2017-10-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FBGFIEQ027S	R-squared:	0.870			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.869			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1103.			
Date:	Mon, 14 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.84e-75			
Time:	17:07:08	Log-Likelihood:	-1926.0			
No. Observations:	167	AIC:	3856.			
Df Residuals:	165	BIC:	3862.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.341e+04	3837.676	3.493	0.001	5829.236	2.1e+04
value_fred_ATNHPIUS37100Q	745.7296	22.457	33.207	0.000	701.389	790.070
Omnibus:	1.131	Durbin-Watson:	0.039			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.568	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.803			
Skew:	-0.148	Prob(JB):	0.669			
Kurtosis:	3.165	Cond. No.	341.			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

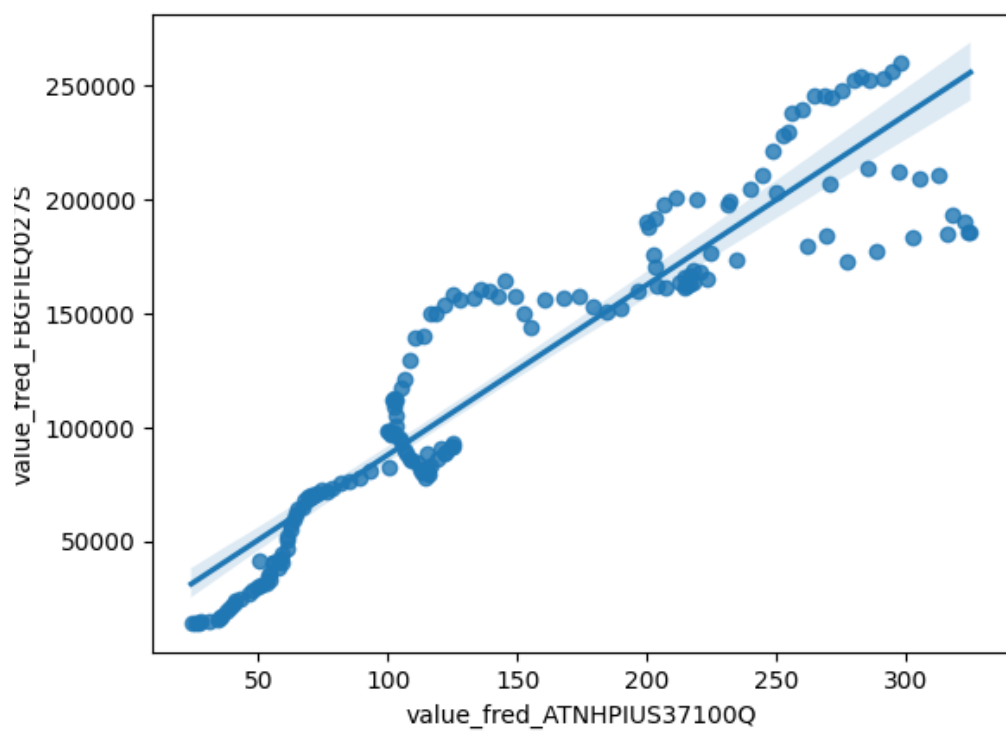


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-14

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_FBGFIEQ027S_detrended	R-squared:	0.233
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.228
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	50.05
Date:	Mon, 14 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	4.06e-11
Time:	17:07:08	Log-Likelihood:	-1814.4
No. Observations:	167	AIC:	3633.
Df Residuals:	165	BIC:	3639.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.573e-09	985.135	-1.6e-12	1.000	-1945.095	1945.095
value_fred_ATNHPIUS37100Q_detrended	197.7479	27.952	7.075	0.000	142.559	252.937

Omnibus:	3.074	Durbin-Watson:	0.100
Prob(Omnibus):	0.215	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.616
Skew:	-0.248	Prob(JB):	0.270
Kurtosis:	3.361	Cond. No.	35.2

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

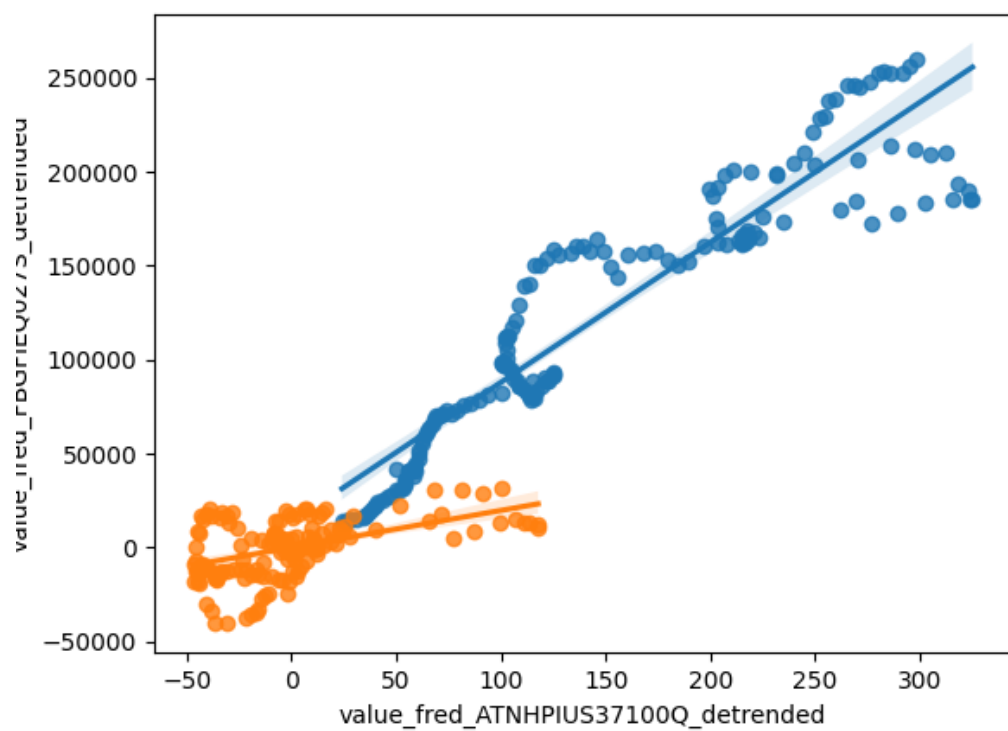


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-14

3 Date: 2026-09-15

Series ID: ATNHPIUS42020Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for San Luis Obispo-Paso Robles, CA (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1977-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 8.

Series ID: EARPRXDBNQ

This series is titled Percent of Value of Loans Prime Based by Average Loan Size (\$ thousands), Prime, Domestic Banks (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly, 2nd Month's 1st Full Week. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-04-01 and the observation end date is 2017-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EARPRXDBNQ	R-squared:	0.039
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.027
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	3.241
Date:	Tue, 15 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0756
Time:	15:46:24	Log-Likelihood:	-364.17
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	732.3
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	737.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	176.5714	8.976	19.671	0.000	158.704	194.438
value_fred_ATNHPIUS42020Q	0.0686	0.038	1.800	0.076	-0.007	0.144

Omnibus:	0.239	Durbin-Watson:	1.271
Prob(Omnibus):	0.887	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.081
Skew:	-0.077	Prob(JB):	0.960
Kurtosis:	3.017	Cond. No.	866.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.



3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_EARPRXDBNQ_detrended	R-squared:	0.027
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.015
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.188
Date:	Tue, 15 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.143
Time:	15:46:25	Log-Likelihood:	-356.02
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	716.0
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	720.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-4.581e-12	2.207	-2.08e-12	1.000	-4.393	4.393
value_fred_ATNHPIUS42020Q_detrended	-0.0708	0.048	-1.479	0.143	-0.166	0.024

Omnibus:	1.694	Durbin-Watson:	1.556
Prob(Omnibus):	0.429	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.096
Skew:	0.241	Prob(JB):	0.578
Kurtosis:	3.303	Cond. No.	46.1

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

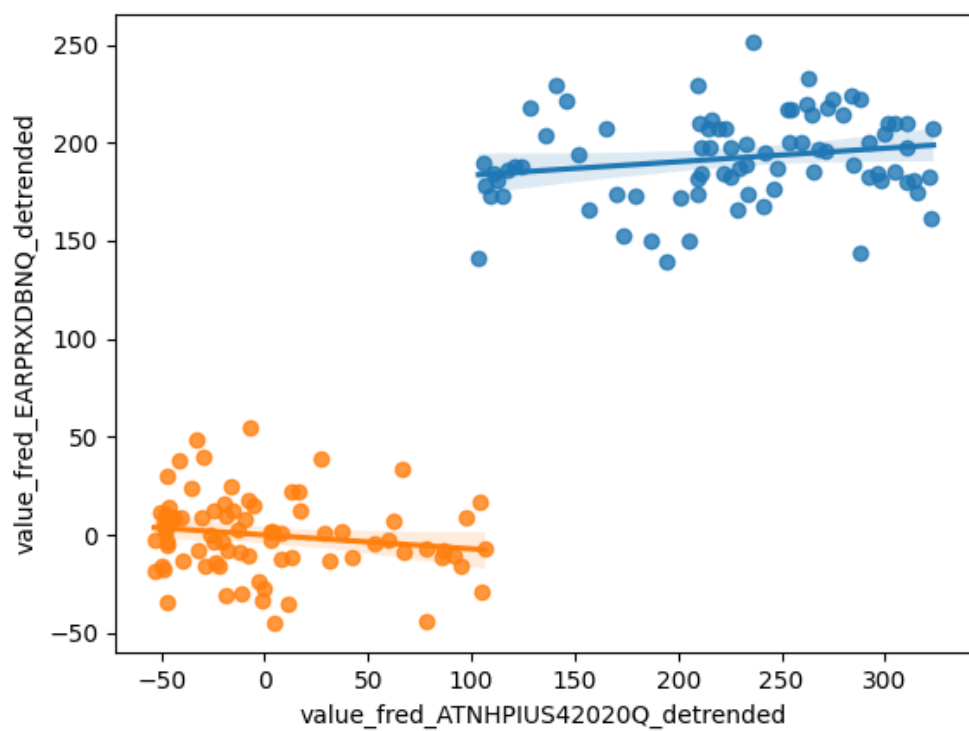


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-15

4 Date: 2026-09-16

Series ID: EMISSCO2VDFCCBA

This series is titled Distillate Fuel Commercial Sector Carbon Dioxide Emissions and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Million Metric Tons CO2 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1973-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BRVSLV02JPQ460S

This series is titled Business Tendency Surveys: Volume of Stocks: Economic Activity: Retail Trade, Except of Motor Vehicles and Motorcycles: Current for Japan and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Percentage balance and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1990-10-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BRVSLV02JPQ460S	R-squared:	0.481
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.465
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	29.65
Date:	Wed, 16 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.44e-06
Time:	15:39:06	Log-Likelihood:	-112.36
No. Observations:	34	AIC:	228.7
Df Residuals:	32	BIC:	231.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-20.4615	6.786	-3.015	0.005	-34.285	-6.638
value_fred_EMISSCO2VDFCCBA	1.2106	0.222	5.445	0.000	0.758	1.664

Omnibus:	6.618	Durbin-Watson:	1.027
Prob(Omnibus):	0.037	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.041
Skew:	-0.838	Prob(JB):	0.0804
Kurtosis:	3.867	Cond. No.	178.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

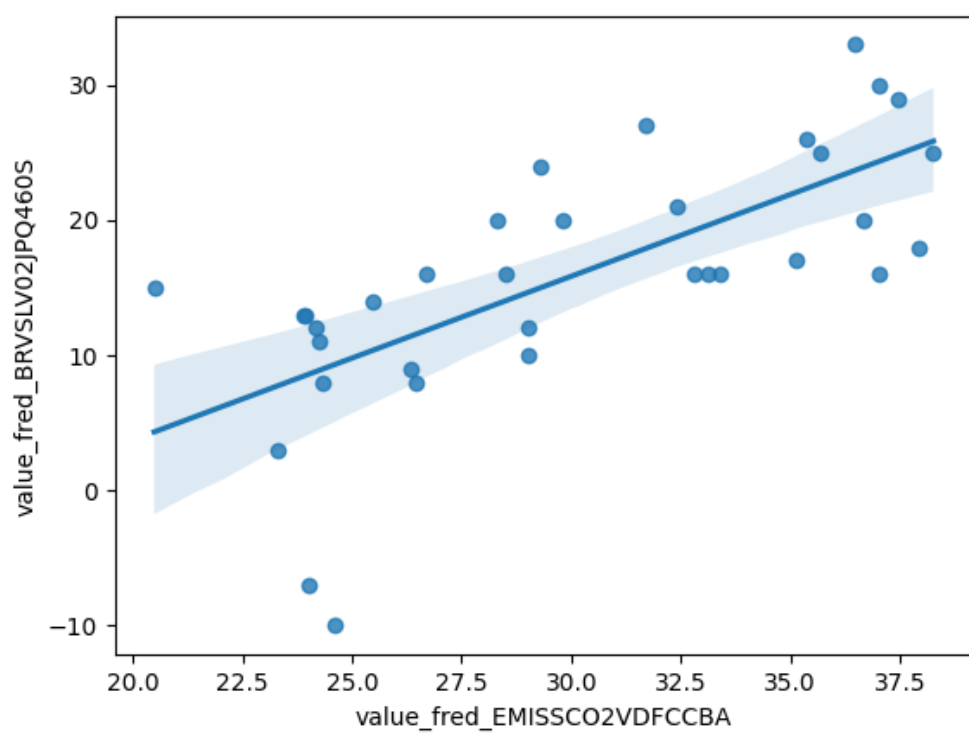


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-16

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BRVSLV02JPQ460S_detrended	R-squared:	0.166
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.140
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	6.379
Date:	Wed, 16 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0167
Time:	15:39:06	Log-Likelihood:	-100.08
No. Observations:	34	AIC:	204.2
Df Residuals:	32	BIC:	207.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-6.513e-13	0.812	-8.02e-13	1.000	-1.654	1.654
value_fred_EMISSCO2VDFCCBA_detrended	-1.0600	0.420	-2.526	0.017	-1.915	-0.205

Omnibus:	7.112	Durbin-Watson:	1.687
Prob(Omnibus):	0.029	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.544
Skew:	-0.868	Prob(JB):	0.0625
Kurtosis:	3.947	Cond. No.	1.93

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

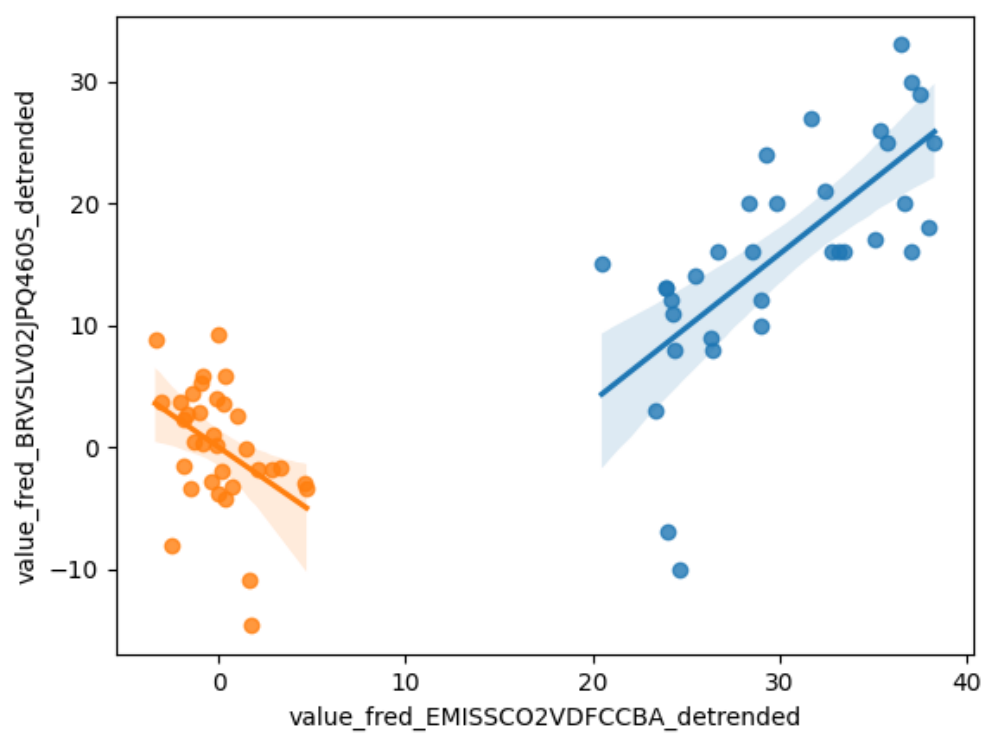


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-16

5 Date: 2026-09-17

Series ID: IIPUSASSQ

This series is titled U.S. Assets and has a frequency of Quarterly, End of Period. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2006-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 10.

Series ID: BSCICP035AM665S

This series is titled Composite Leading Indicators: Composite Business Confidence Amplitude Adjusted for Major Five Asia Economies and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Normalised (Normal=100) and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-02-01 and the observation end date is 2023-12-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BSCICP035AM665S	R-squared:	0.083
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.070
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	6.363
Date:	Thu, 17 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0139
Time:	15:45:16	Log-Likelihood:	-123.79
No. Observations:	72	AIC:	251.6
Df Residuals:	70	BIC:	256.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	101.6727	0.802	126.848	0.000	100.074	103.271
value_fred_IIPUSASSQ	-8.045e-08	3.19e-08	-2.522	0.014	-1.44e-07	-1.68e-08

Omnibus:	13.288	Durbin-Watson:	0.449
Prob(Omnibus):	0.001	Jarque-Bera (JB):	16.146
Skew:	-0.826	Prob(JB):	0.000312
Kurtosis:	4.628	Cond. No.	1.25e+08

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.25e+08. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

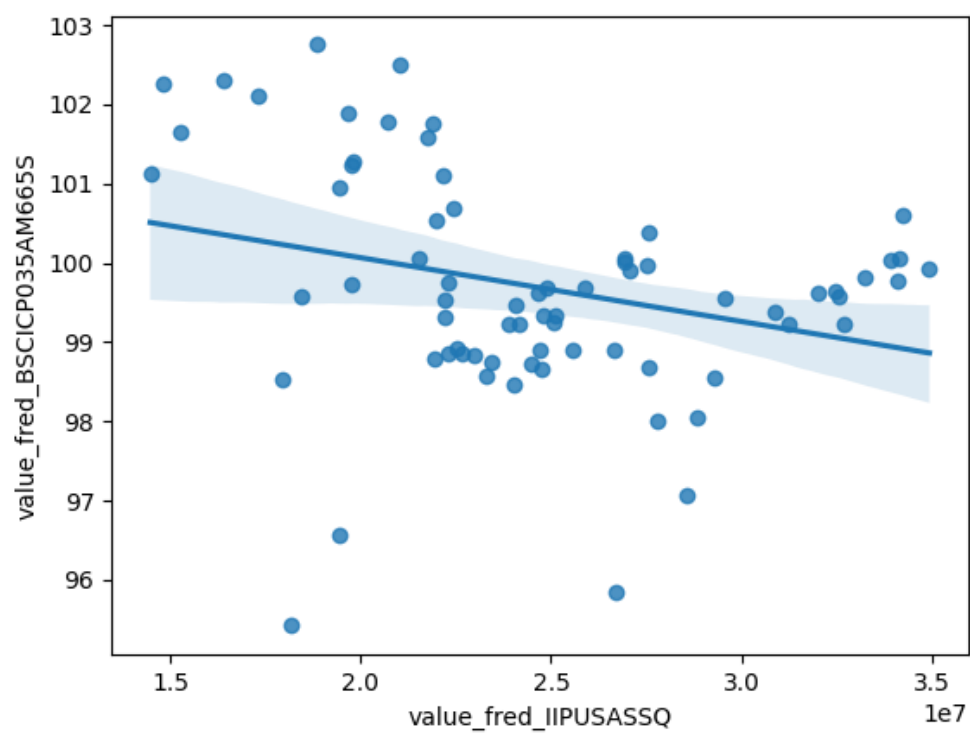


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-17

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BSCICP035AM665S_detrended	R-squared:	0.178
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.167
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	15.21
Date:	Thu, 17 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.000219
Time:	15:45:16	Log-Likelihood:	-112.66
No. Observations:	72	AIC:	229.3
Df Residuals:	70	BIC:	233.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-2.082e-12	0.138	-1.51e-11	1.000	-0.276	0.276
value_fred_IIPUSASSQ_detrended	3.494e-07	8.96e-08	3.900	0.000	1.71e-07	5.28e-07

Omnibus:	26.580	Durbin-Watson:	0.538
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	53.882
Skew:	-1.260	Prob(JB):	1.99e-12
Kurtosis:	6.407	Cond. No.	1.54e+06

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.54e+06. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

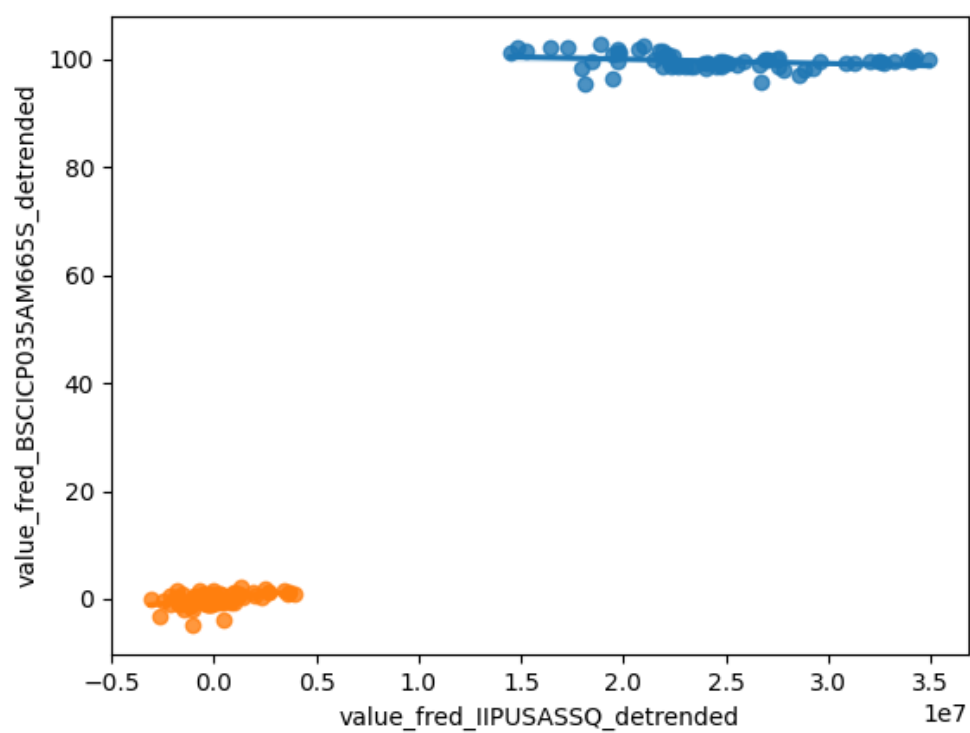


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-17

6 Date: 2026-09-18

Series ID: BAMLEMHGHGLCRPIUSTRIV

This series is titled ICE BofA High Grade US Emerging Markets Liquid Corporate Plus Index Total Return Index Value and has a frequency of Daily. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2023-09-19 and the observation end date is 2026-09-17. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: CUUR0000SEHF02

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Utility (Piped) Gas Service in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 1982-1984=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1935-03-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01. The popularity of this series is 9.

6.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CUUR0000SEHF02	R-squared:	0.732
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.717
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	49.05
Date:	Fri, 18 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.54e-06
Time:	15:17:42	Log-Likelihood:	-71.934
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	147.9
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	149.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-12.4578	36.807	-0.338	0.739	-89.787	64.871
value_fred_BAMLEMHGHGLCRPIUSTRIV	1.0247	0.146	7.004	0.000	0.717	1.332

Omnibus:	1.439	Durbin-Watson:	0.633
Prob(Omnibus):	0.487	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.769
Skew:	-0.480	Prob(JB):	0.681
Kurtosis:	2.969	Cond. No.	4.45e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 4.45e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

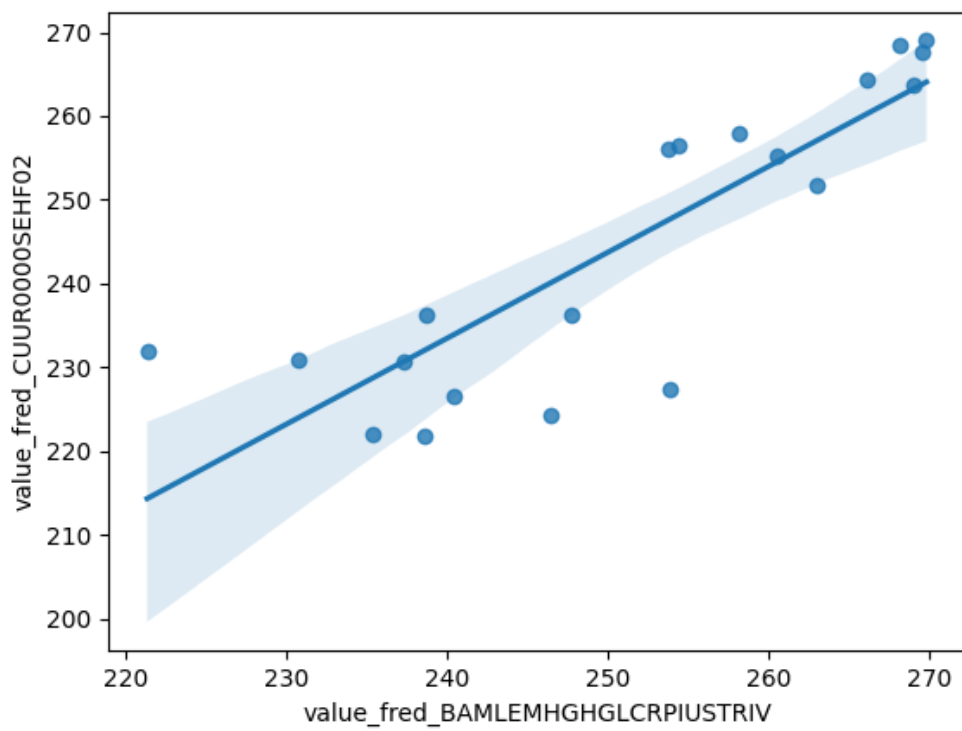


Figure 9: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-18

6.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CUUR0000SEHF02_detrended	R-squared:	0.056
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.003
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1.063
Date:	Fri, 18 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.316
Time:	15:17:42	Log-Likelihood:	-66.774
No. Observations:	20	AIC:	137.5
Df Residuals:	18	BIC:	139.5
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.553e-11	1.607	9.66e-12	1.000	-3.377	3.377
value_fred_BAMLEMHGHGLCRPIUSTRIV_detrended	-0.4521	0.438	-1.031	0.316	-1.373	0.469

Omnibus:	3.477	Durbin-Watson:	0.858
Prob(Omnibus):	0.176	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.332
Skew:	0.090	Prob(JB):	0.514
Kurtosis:	1.749	Cond. No.	3.67

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

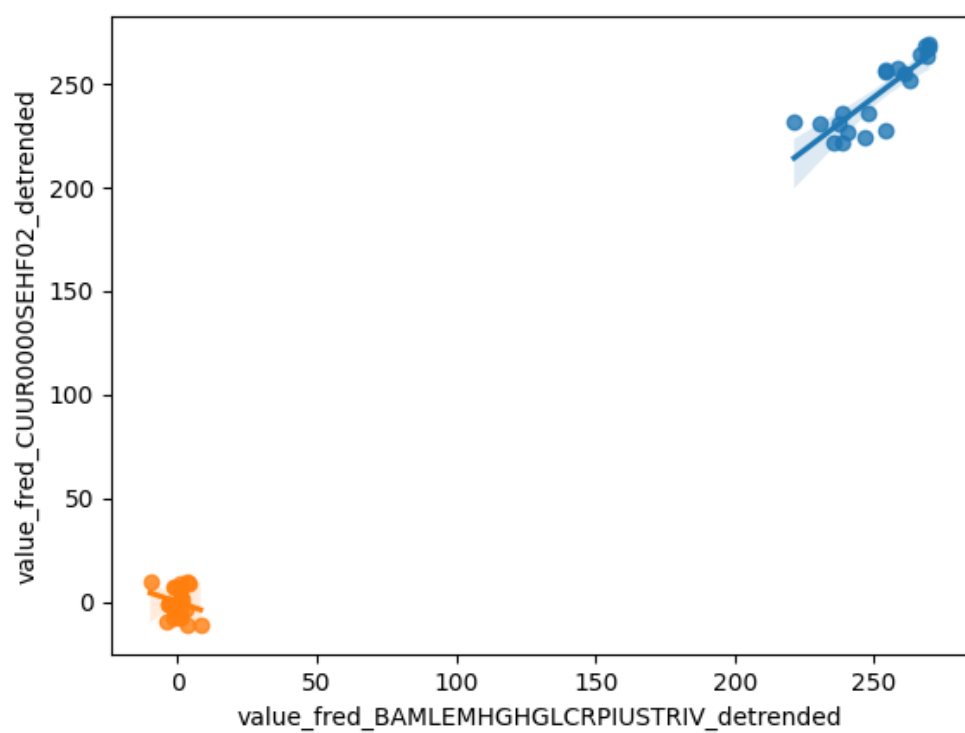


Figure 10: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-18

7 Date: 2026-09-19

Series ID: JTU6200OSR

This series is titled Other Separations: Health Care and Social Assistance and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: JTU4400HIR

This series is titled Hires: Retail Trade and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

7.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_JTU4400HIR	R-squared:	0.011			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.007			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	3.313			
Date:	Sat, 19 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0697			
Time:	14:54:03	Log-Likelihood:	-414.91			
No. Observations:	308	AIC:	833.8			
Df Residuals:	306	BIC:	841.3			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.9928	0.175	28.499	0.000	4.648	5.338
value_fred_JTU6200OSR	-1.5143	0.832	-1.820	0.070	-3.151	0.123
Omnibus:	5.215	Durbin-Watson:	0.754			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.074	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.214			
Skew:	0.318	Prob(JB):	0.0737			
Kurtosis:	2.971	Cond. No.	16.3			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

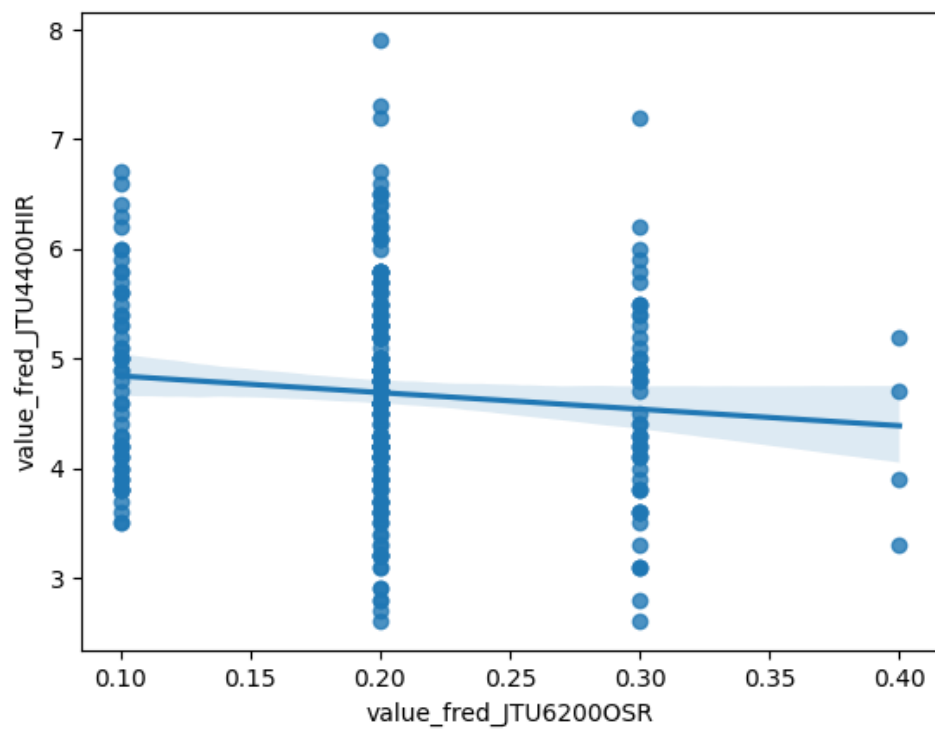


Figure 11: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-19

7.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_JTU4400HIR_detrended	R-squared:	0.023
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.020
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	7.277
Date:	Sat, 19 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00737
Time:	14:54:03	Log-Likelihood:	-409.05
No. Observations:	308	AIC:	822.1
Df Residuals:	306	BIC:	829.6
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	7.77e-13	0.052	1.49e-11	1.000	-0.103	0.103
value_fred_JTU6200OSR_detrended	-2.2825	0.846	-2.698	0.007	-3.947	-0.618

Omnibus:	7.615	Durbin-Watson:	0.790
Prob(Omnibus):	0.022	Jarque-Bera (JB):	7.440
Skew:	0.352	Prob(JB):	0.0242
Kurtosis:	3.289	Cond. No.	16.2

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

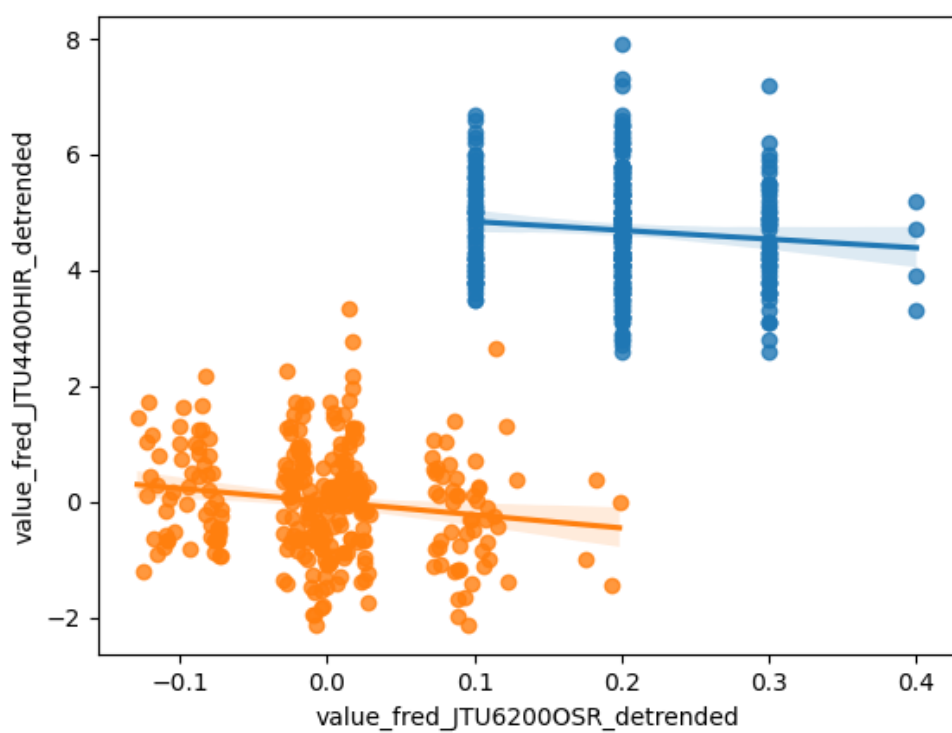


Figure 12: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-19